What Day 1 taught

and what happened since

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Where we are today

→	**What Day 1 taught** ← you are here
	What Claude needs in every session
	What Claude needs only sometimes
	Your own skill
	Lunch
	A history you can go back to
	Where does this file live?
	Commit first, then let Claude move things. Then GitHub
	Wrap, done at 17:00

How it works

1. **What Claude Code is.** The model writes text. Claude Code turns some of that text into actions: it reads and edits your files, runs commands, and hands the results back to the model.
2. **How Claude Code reaches the model.** Your launcher sets two things before Claude Code starts. The address says where the request goes. The key says who pays.
3. **Why a session needs files.** The model does not remember. It is handed the whole conversation again, every turn. So anything that has to last goes in a file.
4. **Which files.** Your instruction files, the `CLAUDE.md` files first, are always loaded. Your notes, a paper or a codebook are read on demand. Always loaded is always there, and takes up room in every turn. On demand takes none, and is read only if something leads Claude there.

What follows for the work

1. Pick the role before the first prompt: coder, discussion partner, reviewer, writer / editor, research assistant, measuring device, tutor or secretary.
2. You ask. Claude writes. You read it and decide.
3. When Claude says it did something, `Ctrl+O` shows what it did.
4. The model writes the likely next token. A reference or a number can be invented, so the source has to come from outside.
5. Put the session where the work is, and give it a name.
6. Rewind past a mistake instead of correcting on top of it.
7. Every word in a prompt takes weight from every other. Irrelevant material is not skipped.

What happened since?

- Did Claude do something since yesterday that you did not expect?
- Is a question from yesterday still open?

Where did you stop yesterday?

Your project · free time

- Start a new session in your project and ask: *"Read* `claude/next_steps.md`*. Where did we stop, and what would you do first?"*
- Could you pick up the work from that answer? If not, tell Claude what was missing.